

BIG MONEY

Ola has seen the highest fundraising among the three big aggregators

NOTE THIS DOES NOT INCLUDE DEBT FUNDING

* DATA AS OF

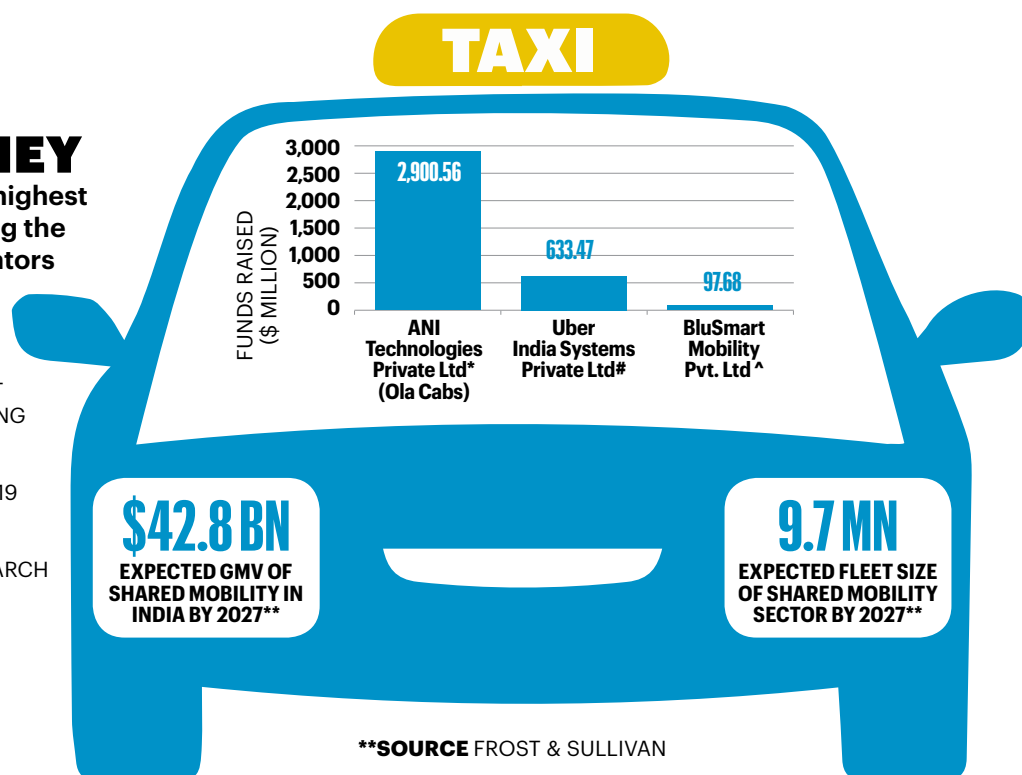
NOVEMBER 2022

DATA AS OF OCT 2019

^ DATA AS MAY 2023

SOURCE

PRIVATECIRCLE RESEARCH



“With Bhavish (Aggarwal, Ola’s CEO), they were never able to [agree] on a valuation. Bhavish would always say ‘you are smaller and I’m bigger,’ and they would never reach consensus. If Bhavish were to give it a chance, SoftBank would have funded [the transaction to acquire Uber’s operations] to create a monopoly. I don’t think Uber ever received a good valuation in India. That is why they haven’t left the market,” says the VC.

Others paint a different picture. According to some industry watchers, Uber has gained market share at Ola’s expense. “In 2021-22, Ola had higher market share, probably just above 50 per cent. It is now in the high 30s. Uber has a profession-

al leadership and stable team, and they kept executing really well,” says a former entrepreneur in the mobility sector.

Uber has recently led a \$20-million investment round in fleet management firm Everest Fleet to provide its drivers with better access to electric vehicles (EVs).

Prabhjeet Singh, President of Uber India and South Asia, tells *BT* that the company is focussing on new categories in cities where it is operating, while expanding new products in other regions. “We have widened our geographical presence, introduced buses, and achieved growth in all aspects, including category expansion,” he says.

Uber is also going aggressive on

the multi-model opportunity. According to Singh, one out of two trips on Uber is on two- or three-wheelers. “We have also expanded Reserve, our pre-booked travel offering, to 13 cities. I am excited about high-capacity vehicles in India. We are running bus pilots in Gurugram and a smaller one in Bengaluru and I am very keen to explore the possibilities. And more recently we have introduced Uber Green in India, our global flagship EV product, which means you can now get an EV at the tap of [the] app,” he says.

EYE ON EVs

Meanwhile, Bhavish Aggarwal and Ola appear to be solely focussed on the EV business, per sources, a de-